William M. Newman

University of Wyoming Department of Geology & Geophysics

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RESEARCH PROFILE

I am a graduate student studying paleobotany and paleoecology during the Paleogene. I am interested in the response of plants to insect herbivory during times of increased feeding stress.

EDUCATION

Ph.D.	University of Wyoming – Geology and Geophysics
B.S. 2025	University of Michigan – Ecology, Evolution, and Biodiversity | Minor Earth and Environmental Sciences

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2025-2026	Research Assistant – Isotopologue Paleosciences Laboratory | University of Michigan
2021-2022	Research Assistant – Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program | Valdovinos Lab | University of Michigan

FIELDWORK EXPERIENCE

2026	Paleontology Field Assistant – Weaver Lab | University of Michigan
2026	Paleontology Field Assistant – Isotopologue Paleosciences Laboratory & Weaver Lab | University of Michigan

CURRENT MANUSCRIPTS

Allen, M. L., Wisniewski, A., Unruh-Friesen, E., **Newman, W.,** Weaver, L. N., Passey, B. H. [in prep]. Paired clumped (d47) and triple oxygen (d17) isotope analyses of pedogenic carbonates reveal terrestrial climate variability and carbonate formation seasonality across the Late Paleocene–Early Eocene.

ABSTRACTS

2026	Climatic and Biotic Events of the Paleogene – Allen, M. L., Wisniewski, A., Unruh-Friesen, E., **Newman, W.,** Passey, B. H. Hot Before the Hyperthermal? New Terrestrial Temperature Constraints Across the Late Paleocene–PETM Transition
2026	Geological Society of America Annual Meeting – Allen, M. L., Wisniewski, A., Unruh-Friesen, E., **Newman, W.,** Weaver, L. N., Passey, B. H. Paired clumped (d47) and triple oxygen (d17) isotope analyses of pedogenic carbonates reveal terrestrial climate variability and carbonate formation seasonality across the Late Paleocene–Early Eocene.
2026	Society of Vertebrate Paleontology Annual Meeting – Unruh-Friesen, E. G., Allen, M. L., **Newman, W. M.,** Weaver, L. N., Passey, B. H. Evaluating the water balance thermo-physiology of late Miocene equids using triple oxygen isotopes of fossil tooth enamel.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2024-2026 Docent – University of Michigan Museum of Natural History

AWARDS

2024 Loyal E. Luikart Memorial Scholarship, $3,000
2023 William D. Revelli Alumni Band Scholarship, $2,200

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Geological Society of America

REFERENCES

Dr. Ellen Currano – Professor, University of Wyoming Department of Geology and Geophysics, ecurrano@uwyo.edu
Dr. Naomi Levin – Professor, University of Michigan Department of Earth and Environmental Sciences, nelevin@umich.edu